

Rhea entrusted Zeus to the care of Gaia, who looked after him until he reached adulthood. When Zeus was fully grown, he decided to try and free his brothers and sisters. He approached Metis, goddess of advice. “Can you help me free my siblings from the stomach of Cronos?” Zeus asked.

“I can brew a potion for you that will make Cronos sick, if you can slip it into his drink,” Metis offered.

*Zeus took the potion from Metis, and set about planning how to trick his father into drinking it.*

With the help of his mother, Rhea, Zeus sneaked into Cronos’s palace dressed as the cupbearer who served drinks to the gods. Never having seen his youngest son, Cronos did not recognize Zeus. He happily drank the wine Zeus poured for him, unaware that it had been mixed with Metis’s potion.

After only a few sips, Cronos turned pale. His stomach churned and his head began to spin, then “BLEURGH!” Cronos vomited up the swaddled stone, quickly followed by Poseidon, Hades, Hera, Demeter, and Hestia, now all fully grown. Zeus had freed them at last from their gruesome prison.

*Cronos heaved and all the children he had swallowed emerged.*

